

Alla Vostra Mobile App Work Log - June 10, 2026

Compiled summary for June 10, 2026 - focus: Expo SDK 54 / Expo Go recovery, Android native navigation-bar hardening, Home-image transparency repairs, product bullet styling, header chevron color consistency, and the convenience2 mosaic/shards pipeline for About Us.

Includes tracked Git work from the June 10 mobile-app session, local runtime notes, image-generation decisions, and the final repository state after the mosaic handoff.

Generated automatically for the June 10, 2026 daily worklog after the About Us mosaic/shards image was accepted as good enough and applied to the app.

Source Materials Processed

- Read the existing root-level worklog PDFs, especially June 6 part 2, June 9, and May 27, to preserve the established PDF size, typography, title wording, footer cadence, section order, and compact bullet-heavy report style.
- Reviewed Git history for June 10 and the immediately-following after-midnight cleanup, including commits 122e0f4, 99e34bd, 7270302, 42523e0, 99015d0, 44b0484, 66023a7, and 7c84e71.
- Inspected active Home and About Us image usage, including index.js, aboutus.js, sharedStyles.js, aboutusStyles.js, and the current tile-blend PNG assets.
- Checked the current repository path after the project move. The active root is now /Users/prahlin/alla_vostra even though older snapshots and worklogs refer to /Users/prahlin/Desktop/alla_vostra.
- Checked repository status before generation and confirmed main matched origin/main before adding this worklog artifact.

Current Baseline to Preserve

- Primary app work now lives in /Users/prahlin/alla_vostra/mob with Expo Router, Expo SDK 54, React Native 0.81.5, and Expo Go on the Samsung S21 FE as the practical runtime target.
- The usual phone start path is still npx expo start --tunnel --clear from the mob directory, then opening the tunnel URL in Expo Go. USB is useful for native device commands but not required for Expo Go over tunnel.
- Home feature images use tall tile-blend both variants at 853x1280, displayed with the same 1280 / 853 aspect ratio and windowWidth * 1.05 width calculation.
- The orange Android native navigation bar is deliberately enforced at runtime and through restored calls after app-state or visibility changes, because Expo Go can reset native system chrome unexpectedly.
- Top nav chevrons should remain black when shown together, regardless of old/middle/new header state, and should not regress back to light gray.
- Shop remains visually distinct from the main overlay-header pages, while Home, Products, About Us, and Contact continue to share the persistent header and swipe/navigation architecture.

Main Goals We Worked Toward

- Get the freshly cloned SDK 54 project running again through Expo Go without chasing Android Studio emulator assumptions when the desired workflow was a physical S21 FE.
- Make the Android bottom system navigation bar stay orange, then improve icon contrast within the native limitations of Expo Go and Android system controls.
- Repair the active Home mosaic assets so intended transparent regions are truly transparent and tile extensions no longer contain tiny prickles or accidental pinholes.
- Remove obsolete top/bottom mockup-only image files once the both-side tile-blend variants became the only active Home assets.
- Generate a convenience2-derived mosaic/shards asset that could replace the About Us photograph while matching the Home-screen visual language.
- Document the mosaic/shards lessons carefully enough that future image touch-ups can reproduce the look faster and with fewer failed iterations.

Work Completed - Expo Go / SDK 54 Runtime Recovery

- Clarified the correct command syntax after the earlier `npx expo start--clear` confusion. The usable command is `npx expo start --clear`, with `--tunnel` preferred for phone testing when LAN discovery is unreliable.
- Separated Android Studio / emulator issues from the actual user workflow. Android Studio was already installed, but Expo Go on the physical S21 FE was the target, so pressing a is not the normal path unless using USB or an emulator.
- Diagnosed the spinning Expo Go load state as a stale or wrong connection path rather than a reason to reclone the repository. Switching to a tunnel URL was the durable workaround for local network/device discovery problems.
- Explained that leaving the computer idle can break an Expo Go session because Metro, tunnel state, phone app cache, IP/LAN reachability, and native system chrome can drift while the code itself remains fine.
- Produced a six-step recovery checklist for future phone startup: kill stale Metro, start tunnel with a clean cache, wait for Metro readiness, open Expo Go manually, paste the tunnel URL if scanning fails, and reload from Expo Go after connection succeeds.
- Moved the project from `/Users/prahlin/Desktop/alla_vostra` to `/Users/prahlin/alla_vostra` after verifying the move would preserve dependencies, Git history, `node_modules`, Expo files, and GitHub remote configuration.

Work Completed - Android Native Navigation Bar

- Fixed the Android native bottom navigation bar so the orange background survives after app startup instead of appearing briefly and then disappearing.
- Kept the bottom native navigation bar color aligned with the top brand bar color `#f7b967`.
- Confirmed that true black Android navigation icons are not available through the Expo Go/native API path in this setup, then moved to a light/white button style for stronger contrast than the previous gray appearance.
- Added runtime reapplication points so the orange bar and icon style are restored after visibility changes, app-state changes, and initial mount timing.
- Kept the native Android workaround separate from the web preview, where browser chrome does not represent the phone system navigation bar.

Work Completed - Header and Products Visual Adjustments

- Replaced generic Products-screen ingredient bullets with orange, black-bordered right-facing triangle indicators so the list treatment better matches the Italian/playful culinary theme.
- Restored black top-nav chevrons after the arrows continued to appear gray in Expo Go. The final desired behavior is that header arrows are fully black when displayed together across old, middle, and new app-header states.
- Hardened AppHeader opacity behavior so chevrons are either intentionally visible or hidden rather than inheriting faint, state-dependent gray values.
- Left the moving orange page indicator behavior unchanged during this worklog period, after a later request to make indicators optimistic was explicitly withdrawn before implementation.

Work Completed - Home Image Transparency and Pinholes

- Investigated why the active Home-screen tile-blend images looked like they still had faint background color in regions meant to be transparent.
- Confirmed the issue was in the actual currently visible active PNGs, not only unused mockups or stale generated variants.
- Repaired the alpha channels in the active Passion, Taste, and Convenience tile-blend both images so transparent areas allow the page background and background1 image to show through correctly.

- Removed tiny accidental pinholes/prickles from top/bottom added tile regions in the active Home assets. These artifacts came from generated-image transparency or alpha noise rather than intentional mosaic texture.
- Permanently deleted the obsolete top-only and bottom-only mockup image files once the both-side images were accepted as the active Home-screen assets.
- Validated the repaired Home image files with alpha-channel checks and preserved the 853x1280 portrait dimensions for the active Home image pipeline.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - Problem Framing

- The user wanted convenience2.jpg extended vertically by 50% total, with 25% added above and 25% below, without changing horizontal crop or widening the image.
- The visual target was not a new food photograph and not a busy object-filled generated scene. The added regions needed to stay plain, gray/warm, and compatible with the simple surface already present at the top and bottom of convenience2.jpg.
- The final desired image needed to become a mosaic asset, not merely an extended photograph, and it needed to fit the same Home-screen family as taste111_mos9, convenience111_mos9, and passion111_mos9.
- The user repeatedly clarified that tiles must be one hex/shade/color per tile. Color variation belongs between tiles, not inside a single tile, except for the very modest texture already present in the accepted reference mosaics.
- The image still needed to be clearly readable as a cheese board. The mosaic effect could stylize the image, but could not obscure the subject into abstract tile noise.
- The added top/bottom shard fields needed to be transparent where no shards exist. Any faint rectangular haze or invisible square is a failure because it becomes visible against the cream page background.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - Reference Assets and Exact Geometry

- The most important reference for vertical extension was taste111_mos9_bright_soft_mockup_tile_blend_both_mockup.png.
- That reference establishes the exact canvas math: a square 853x853 source becomes 853x1280, with the original square placed at y=213, 213px added above, and 214px added below.
- The active Home treatment displays tall assets with $\text{featureImageAspectRatio} = 1280 / 853$ and $\text{width} = \text{windowWidth} * 1.05$. About Us now follows the same math for visual consistency.
- In the reference both image, the top and bottom extension bands contain no fully opaque pixels. They are made of transparent, low-alpha, and medium-alpha shard regions, so they blend into the cream page instead of forming hard panels.
- The square source is pasted over the shard field, leaving the shard layer visible only in transparent edge gaps and the added vertical areas. This layering principle is essential for matching the Home images.
- The final convenience2 square mosaic is named convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient_mos9.png and the tall About Us-ready version is convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient_mos9_tile_blend_both_mockup.png.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - What Failed and Why

- Early procedural mosaics failed because they tried to invent tile geometry and palette from scratch. They became overcorrected, ugly, too abstract, or inconsistent with the Taste/Convenience/Passion mos9 family.
- Attempts with large background shards failed because the tile sizes were not consistent. Oversized slabs behind medium mosaic pieces made the extension feel like a separate collage rather than the same visual system.
- Attempts that filled gaps with translucent sampled strips failed because they created an invisible square or rectangular wash. Even low alpha becomes visible when the rest of the asset is truly transparent.
- Attempts that let loose shards cross the square-source boundary failed because the base mosaic overlay recolored or covered only part of the shard. The result was a single shard split in half by the hidden square boundary.

- Attempts that made the bridge too dense failed by losing the airy top/bottom falloff. The user wanted the gaps to be filled near the mosaic, but still more prominent toward the extreme top and bottom.
- Attempts that leaned too gray failed because the edge-adjacent shards stopped belonging to the cheese-board mosaic. The closer a shard is to the main image, the more it needs source color and opacity.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - Final Accepted Recipe

- Start from the accepted square mosaic, not the original photograph, once the user approves the square mos9 result. Preserve that square image exactly wherever it has alpha.
- Create a new 853x1280 canvas and position the square source at y=213. Never overwrite the square source; always create a sibling both mockup file.
- Use a continuous shard layer across the full 853x1280 canvas, but then hard-preserve the base square mosaic wherever base alpha exists. This prevents invisible-square split-color artifacts.
- Drive shard placement from the actual jagged alpha outline of the source mosaic, not from the rectangular source boundary. Edge-following placement removes awkward moat gaps.
- Use denser, more opaque, source-colored shards immediately adjacent to the mosaic edge. Then reduce opacity and density as shards move toward the far top and bottom of the canvas.
- Keep shard sizes in the same medium range as the reference mosaic tiles. Do not mix in giant background slabs or tiny noisy fragments unless the reference image already supports them.
- Keep each shard a single flat shade with only very subtle texture/edge antialiasing. If a shard appears split, gradient-filled, or multi-object-like, regenerate or clip it differently.
- Render previews both raw and composited on #FFFCF2. Raw transparency exposes alpha mistakes; cream compositing exposes invisible-square haze and awkward whitespace.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - Practical Future Rules

- Before generating new variants, inspect the existing accepted family: passion111_mos9.png, taste111_mos9.png, convenience111_mos9.png, and the active *_tile_blend_both_mockup.png files.
- If the user says a mosaic is too grainy, do not add more texture. Smooth or simplify tile fills while preserving object readability.
- If the user says the shards have awkward gaps, add edge-following medium fragments near the alpha outline rather than filling the whole rectangular band.
- If the user says the invisible square is showing, check for any nonzero alpha in rectangular regions that are not actual shard silhouettes or base image pixels.
- If the user says shards are multicolored or split in half, make the loose-shard layer continuous first, then preserve the base square exactly instead of compositing over half of a shard.
- If the user says the image no longer clearly shows the subject, reduce procedural abstraction and return to the approved image-generation result as the content source.
- For future About/Home assets, record dimensions, alpha stats, reference file, and final display math in the worklog so the next image pass starts from measurable constraints.

Mosaic / Shards Deep Dive - About Us Integration

- The accepted convenience2 mosaic/shards asset was applied to the About Us screen to replace the old convenience111.png image.
- About Us now imports sharedStyles and uses the same featureImage treatment as Home: transparent background, resizeMode="contain", 1280 / 853 aspect ratio, and windowWidth * 1.05 sizing.
- The About Us source now calculates croppedImageHeight = croppedImageWidth * featureImageAspectRatio, matching the Home tall-image layout instead of using the old square height.
- This limits realistic photographic imagery mostly to Products and Shop, while About Us moves into the same stylized editorial mosaic language as the Home screen.
- The final About Us image path is
mob/convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient_mos9_tile_blend_both_mockup.png.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Used sips and pngjs to confirm image dimensions and alpha-channel behavior while generating and repairing mosaic assets.
- Generated cream-background preview PNGs for mosaic review so transparent regions could be judged as they appear against the app background.
- Parsed aboutus.js with @babel/parser after wiring the new asset into About Us.
- Checked Git history and file stats for the June 10 commits before creating this worklog.
- Verified that the current branch matched origin/main before adding the June 10 worklog PDF.
- Checked PDF output with pdfinfo, pdftotext, and rendered page previews after generation.

Files Touched / Added During June 10 (from tracked commits)

- Modified runtime/layout files: mob/app/_layout.js and mob/app/aboutus.js.
- Modified header files: mob/components/AppHeader.js and mob/styles/headerStyles.js.
- Modified Products styling: mob/app/products.js and mob/styles/productsStyles.js.
- Modified active Home image assets: convenience111, passion111, and taste111 tile-blend both mockups.
- Removed obsolete top-only and bottom-only mockup PNGs for Convenience, Passion, and Taste.
- Added convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient.jpg, convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient_mos9.png, and convenience2_content_fill_mockup_1_plain_gray_gradient_mos9_tile_blend_both_mockup.png.
- Updated package files during image-processing work so the local pngjs-based repair path remained available through the app dependency tree.
- Created this new worklog artifact: alla_vostra_worklog_june10.pdf.

Expo / Metro / Node / GitHub Notes

- Use `cd /Users/prahlin/alla_vostra/mob` before running Expo commands from now on. Older Desktop paths in snapshots are historical.
- Preferred phone command: `npx expo start --tunnel --clear`. If LAN works, `npx expo start --clear --lan` is fine, but tunnel proved more reliable for Expo Go on the S21 FE.
- For web preview only, use `npm run web -- --clear` or `npx expo start --web --clear`. Web does not validate Android native navigation-bar behavior.
- For both phone and web at once, run separate terminal sessions rather than expecting one start command to perfectly serve every runtime state.
- Git status was clean before this PDF was generated. Earlier commit-editor confusion was from a pending/old commit-message process rather than uncommitted code remaining in the worktree.

Important Constraints Going Forward

- Do not reintroduce low-opacity rectangular backgrounds into transparent PNG assets. Transparent areas should be alpha 0 unless they are actual shard/tile silhouettes.
- Do not make Home/About mosaic additions from stock-like or object-filled imagery. The extension areas should remain shard/tile fields that support the original subject.
- Do not overwrite approved square sources when making tall both-side variants. New generated or processed assets should be saved as sibling files with clear names.
- Do not assume pressing a in Expo is the normal path for the S21 FE Expo Go workflow. Use manual Expo Go URL entry or QR/tunnel unless intentionally launching an emulator or USB-connected Android device.
- Do not treat Android native system navigation-bar color as a web-visible feature. Validate it on Expo Go or Android directly.
- Do not let header chevrons become gray again through opacity-state combinations; when shown together, the desired visual target is black.

Best Next Approach

- When beginning another image touch-up, first collect reference dimensions, alpha stats, and the exact consuming screen layout math before generating anything.
- For additional mosaic assets, start with an AI/image-generation pass only for the square subject when the subject needs visual understanding; use deterministic local processing for alpha cleanup, canvas extension, sizing, and file placement.
- If a generated result is close, iterate by changing one visual axis at a time: grain, color, tile size, density, edge blend, or subject readability. Avoid changing all of them at once.
- For Expo Go problems, avoid recloning unless Git state is truly corrupt. Most failures are stale Metro, stale tunnel, wrong URL, phone cache, or local network reachability.
- After any image or native chrome change, test on the actual Android phone because web can hide both alpha-composite perception and native navigation-bar behavior.

Closing Summary

- The June 10 session turned into two tracks: runtime stability and visual-system repair. Expo Go was made usable again through the tunnel workflow, Android native chrome was hardened, and several header/product UI details were brought back into the intended Alla Vostra palette.
- The deeper creative outcome was a reusable mosaic/shards method. The final About Us image now belongs to the same tall, transparent, tile-blend family as Home, and the lessons above should make future image touch-ups faster, less frustrating, and more faithful to the accepted style.

Output Artifact

- Created this worklog PDF: [alla_vostra_worklog_june10.pdf](#).
- No external PDF package was installed; this artifact was generated with the same plain-text-readable standard-library PDF approach used by the recent worklog files.